

UNIVERSITY OF ESSEX

Postgraduate Examinations 2020

PROFESSIONAL PRACTICE AND RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

Time allowed: **TWO** hours (exam time) + **ONE** hour to allow for submission time (total **THREE** hours)

(Please see your exam timetable or check on FASER for the deadline to upload your answers)

The times shown on your timetable are in British Summer Time (BST) (GMT+1). Please check online for a conversion to your local time if you will be undertaking your assessment outside the United Kingdom

Candidates are permitted to use:

Casio FX-83GT PLUS/X or Casio FX-85GT PLUS/X only

The paper consists of **TWENTY TWO** questions. Candidates must answer **ALL** questions in **SECTION A** and **ALL** questions from **SECTION B**. Questions are **NOT** of equal weight.

The percentages shown in brackets provide an indication of the proportion of the total marks for the **PAPER** which will be allocated.

If you have a query with the content of this exam paper please use the revision FAQ Forum on the module's Moodle page. Your academic will be available to answer any queries in real-time.

If you have a technical problem with FASER, or any other query, please go to [Exams Website](#) to find contact details of the teams that can help you.

Please note that the time allocated for this assessment includes time for you to download this question paper and answer paper and to upload your answers to FASER.

Please allow at least 30 minutes at the end of your exam time to upload your work. Once you have completed the assessment do not leave it to the last minute to upload.

Please save your work throughout the examination to avoid losing your work.

Please do not communicate with any other candidate in any way during this assessment. Your response must be your own work. Procedures are in place to detect plagiarism and collusion.

SECTION A

Section A is unavailable

SECTION B**Question 18**

[10%]

A small company has to lease a truck. The company can either pay the lease costs up-front for three years, or it can pay it in annual payments at the start of each year. If the up-front cost is £24,000 for 3 years, or the alternative is an annual cost of £8000 (payable at the beginning of each year), determine whether it is best to pay up-front or by yearly payments, over a 3-year period. You will need to take into account that the inflation rate is 5% per year and the annual payment scheme will be subject to inflation rate rises. Also the bank interest rate is 3%. To do this you will need to determine the Net Present Value (NPV) costs of each method of payment.

What would happen if the bank interest rate increased to 9%? Would this affect your decision?

The formula for NPV is:

$$\frac{X}{(1+r)^t}$$

Where X is the amount to be adjusted, r is the interest rate as a fraction and t is the time period.

Question 19

Citations are the full or partial references that you place into the text of your work to identify the source of evidence presented.

- a) Look at the following three brief extracts and decide for each if a citation is necessary, and if so, where it should go. If a citation is required, your answer should explain where in the text a citation should be placed for each extract. [6%]
- I. *A major study of British school leavers concluded that parents had a major influence on the kind of work entered by their children. The children were influenced over a long period of time by the values and ideas about work of their parents. A later study reached the same conclusion and showed a link between the social and economic status of parents and the work attitudes and aspirations of their teenage children.*
- II. *Climatologists generally agree that the five warmest years since the late nineteenth century have been within the decade, 1995-2005, with the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (NOAA) and the World Meteorological Organization (WMO), ranking 2005 as the second warmest year behind 1998.*
- III. *It has been argued that federalism is a way of making sense of large organisations and that the power and responsibility that drives federalism is a feature of developed societies and can be extended into a way forward for mana*
- b) Give three reasons why you should reference other people's work. [3%]
- c) Give two examples of work that you DO NOT need to reference. [2%]

Question 20

- a) When a job advertisement invites you to apply by submitting an application and CV, the application is generally in the form of a covering letter accompanying the CV. Briefly outline the structure and content that would be expected in a competent application covering letter. [6%]
- b) If you were recruiting for the following role for a Graduate Software Developer, list four things that you would likely be looking for in the successful candidate. [4%]

We are a leading Systems Integrator, with many years' experience working with Blue Chip, FTSE100 customers across the manufacturing industry. Due to expansion we are recruiting a Graduate Software Developer to join our team. The successful candidate will be assisting in the development of software and integrated systems for some of the UK's largest branded manufacturers within industries such as Food and Beverage, Pharmaceutical, Processing and Consumer Packaged Goods. You will further your knowledge by working alongside talented and experienced developers and systems integrators developing software applications using some of the latest technology in the market today. This is a fantastic opportunity to expand your software knowledge within a friendly and fast paced environment.

Question 21

Companies have to submit a financial report each year. The following three financial statements are usually the most important sections of the annual report:

- The Balance Sheet
- The Profit & Loss Account
- The Cash Flow Statement

- a) Describe the purpose of each individual report. [6%]
- b) Describe the relationship between each report and how together they can be used to assess the financial state of a company. [4%]

Question 22

- a) Put the following sentences in the correct order for the *conclusion* to an essay with this title: [4%]

Compare two methods of teaching prepositions and explain which one is more successful

Give your answer as an ordered sequence of letters eg. ABCD

A	<i>Spatial relationships, however, may differ from one language to another, and so this method is not completely effective.</i>
B	<i>By studying spatial relationships, students appear to remember prepositions more accurately than they do using the traditional memorisation method.</i>
C	<i>Nevertheless, the cognitive linguistic approach appears to be useful for many students and it is recommended that researchers study this approach further to see whether it is applicable for students with different language backgrounds and at different levels of language study.</i>
D	<i>This essay has argued that a cognitive linguistics perspective is more effective than simple memorisation in helping students to remember noun and preposition combinations.</i>

- b) What is the purpose of the *Introduction* section to a report? List 2 things that should be included in an *Introduction* section. [4%]

END OF SECTION B

END OF PAPER CE902-7-FY

Once you have completed your answers, please upload them to FASER
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Remember to add your REGISTRATION NUMBER onto ALL documents that you upload.